Casey, and John Poindexter were ganging up on him and pushing foreign policy issues that he opposed behind his back. He felt that I'd lost faith in him. "That isn't true," I wrote in the diary. "As far as I'm concerned, he can stay as long as I'm here." George came to the Oval Office and I told him that we were on the same wavelength and talked him out of resigning. I thank the Lord I did, because he was to be indispensable in our upcoming arms control negotiations with the Soviets.

I don't know what I expected when Father Jenco visited the Oval Office with his family shortly after his release, after a flight from Rome where he had had an audience with the pope. He was a warm man with an impressive gentleness, and very likable—but I was surprised at his reluctance to condemn his captors. I almost sensed he felt sympathy for the Muslims who had held him captive for nineteen months. He didn't seem to want to criticize them, and had no apparent bitterness, making me wonder if it was an example of the "Stockholm syndrome"—when, after a long time together, captives sometimes relate to their captors—or if it was simply his holy nature to forgive even those who had mistreated him.

Father Jenco handed me two letters. The first was a copy of a letter he had written to Pope John Paul II at the request of his captors. It was essentially a condemnation of the West by Shiite Muslims for "exploiting the female body." It also called on the Pope to help the Muslim Shiites—"the poorest of the poor"—who, Jenco said, complained of being denied proper housing, health care, educational opportunities, dignified work, and a voice in government.

Then he gave me a letter addressed to me:

Dear President Reagan: